

Audio Deep Synthesis Detection

ADD 2026: The Third Audio Deep Synthesis Detection Challenge Registration Opens：September 28, 2026 Registration

Challenge Description | Call for Participation | TracksLicenseScheduleEvaluationRulesResults | General Chairs | Organizing Committee

Challenge Description

The ADD 2026 challenge, as the third installment of the ADD challenge series, continues the main objective of encouraging research on the detection of audio deepfake, but with new focuses to better respond to the changing landscapes of the domain. Distinct from ADD 2022 and ADD 2023, ADD 2026 pioneers two unprecedented research dimensions: human impersonation spoofing detection and explainable evaluation for deepfake audio detection.

The ADD 2026 challenge is an IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP) 2027 Signal Processing Grand Challenge. Teams that rank among the top performers in each track and produce innovative work will have the opportunity to present papers on their technical proposals (max. 2 pages) at the ICASSP 2027 conference as part of its SPGC track; a total of five papers will be included in the conference proceedings.

Call for Participation

The past decade of anti-spoofing research, driven by the ASVspoof and ADD challenge series, has produced highly effective countermeasures against machine-generated speech. Yet two gaps remain conspicuously underserved. First, human impersonation, i.e., a live imitator reproducing a target speaker's prosody, timbre, and speech style, leaves none of the digital or signal-level artifacts that most detectors rely on and remains largely absent from mainstream benchmarks despite posing a genuine threat to privacy and public order, in the same way that machine-generated deepfake speech does. Second, as detectors are increasingly deployed in forensic, journalistic, and legal settings, a binary real/fake verdict is no longer sufficient: one needs to know why a sample was judged to be spoofed in a way that is transparent and

verifiable.

The ADD 2026 challenge seeks to address both gaps through two complementary tracks. Together, the tracks aim to push the field toward detection that is both broader in attack coverage and more transparent in its reasoning. We invite participation from researchers in audio forensics, speech processing, machine learning, deepfake detection and speech information security. Participation in a single track is welcome; participants are not required to enter both.

Tracks

Track 1 — Audio impersonation detection (AID): Audio impersonation attacks are defined as a live human imitating the specific acoustic traits and speech style of a target speaker. Unlike machine-generated spoofing attacks (e.g., text-to-speech and voice conversion) that dominate existing benchmarks and academic studies, human impersonation produces artifact-free forged speech with pure human origins. This under-explored spoofing mode poses unique detection challenges, and this track aims to identify such identity-fraudulent yet human-generated utterances. It focuses on distinguishing bona fide speech from human impersonated audio, which poses a challenging, understudied real-world threat scenario.

Track 2 — Explainable audio deepfake detection (EAD): Beyond the conventional binary real/fake classification, real-world forensic and industrial scenarios require detection systems to deliver credible, evidence-based predictions. This track innovatively incorporates explainability evaluation into deepfake detection tasks. This track not only evaluates the accuracy of detection systems, but also evaluates the thoroughness and soundness of reasoning given by these detection systems. Different from conventional detection tasks, this track requires participating systems to not only output accurate fake/genuine predictions but also provide explicit textual reasoning to justify each decision.

License

This dataset is only available for ADD 2026. Permission is granted to use the data given that you agree:

1. That you include a reference to the ADD 2026 Dataset in any work that makes use of the dataset. For research papers, cite our preferred publication as listed on our website and our paper (would be released later); for other media cite our preferred publication as listed on our website

2. That you do not distribute this dataset or modified versions.

3. That you may not use the dataset or any derivative work for commercial purposes as, for example, licensing or selling the data, or using the dat with a purpose to procure a commercial gain.

4. That all rights not expressly granted to you are reserved by ADD 2026 organizers.

Schedule

Countdown To Registration Deadline(AOE) 47days 12h 47m 26s

Registration opens, training datasets release	September 28, 2026
Evaluation datasets release	October 15, 2026
Registration deadline	November 23, 2026
Submission deadline	December 7, 2026
Results and rankings release	December 21, 2026
Grand Challenge 2–page paper due	January 7, 2027
Grand Challenge 2–page paper acceptance notification	January 21, 2027
Camera–ready Grand Challenge papers due	January 28, 2027

Evaluation

1. Track 1: Equal Error Rate (EER)

The goals of Track 1 involve the development of a method to distinguish the impersonated samples from its bona fide counterpart, and therefore equal error rate (EER) is used as an evaluation metric for tracks, evaluated as follows:

Participants should assign a real–valued, finite numerical value to each evaluation sample which reflects the support for two competing hypothese namely that the sample data is genuine or spoofed, instead of optimizing a decision threshold. High detection score should indicate a bona fide utterance, and low score should indicate a fake utterance.

Let $P_{\text{fp}}(\theta)$ and $P_{\text{fn}}(\theta)$ denote the false positive and false negative rates at threshold θ:

$$P_{\text{fp}}(\theta) = \frac{\#\{\text{ fake trials with score } > \theta\}}{\#\{\text{ total fake trials }\}}, \quad P_{\text{fn}}(\theta) = \frac{\#\{\text{ genuine trials with score } \leq \theta\}}{\#\{\text{ total genuine trials }\}}$$

in such way that $P_{\text{fp}}(\theta)$ and $P_{\text{fn}}(\theta)$ are, respectively, monotonically decreasing and increasing functions of θ. The EER corresponds to the threshol θ_{EER} at which the two detection error rates are equal, i.e.,

$$EER = P_{\text{fp}}(\theta_{EER}) = P_{\text{fn}}(\theta_{EER})$$

2. Track 2: Detection–gated BERTScore

As Track 2 has the dual objective of detection accuracy as well as rationale quality, we evaluate the score as follows: Let r_i denote the reference rationale, c_i the submitted rationale, y_i the ground–truth label, and $\hat{y}_i$ the submitted Real/Fake prediction for sample i. We compute the rationale similarity as

$$e_i = \text{BERTScore}_{F_1}(c_i, r_i)$$

using the bert–score Python library with lang="en" and its default pretrained encoder. The score for each sample is $q_i = \mathbb{1}[\hat{y}_i = y_i] \times e_i$. Therefore, an incorrectly classified sample receives a score of zero, regardless of its rationale quality. To account for class imbalance, the final Track 2 score is calculated by first averaging q_i separately over the Real and Fake samples and then taking the mean of the two class–level scores. The resulting value is multiplied by 100 to be expressed in percentage, i.e.,

$$Score = 100 \times \frac{1}{2}\left[\frac{1}{N_{\text{Real}}}\sum_{i:y_i=\text{Real}} q_i + \frac{1}{N_{\text{Fake}}}\sum_{i:y_i=\text{Fake}} q_i\right]$$

Before scoring, only the content inside the <Evidence> field is retained. XML tags are removed, consecutive whitespace is normalized, and the <Decision> field is excluded from rationale scoring.

Rules

The evaluation rules for Tracks 1 and 2 are as follows:

1. Participants shall use only the data from the ADD 2026 training and development partitions of the relevant track to construct and train their deepfake detection systems. It is forbidden to use any other external speech dataset.

   The term "external speech dataset" includes, but is not limited to, any other public or in-house corpora, genuine speech or fake speech samples, feature vectors or any statistical descriptors extracted from such data.

2. The usage of evaluation partitions of ADD 2026 dataset is not permitted in training.

   It is also forbidden to use data from a different track of ADD 2026 in the training of participating systems.

3. Participants shall NOT use externally pre-trained models in their submitted system.

   "Externally pre-trained models" include, but is not limited to, any deepfake detectors, speech activity detectors, speaker recognition models or speech recognition models trained on an external dataset.

   For the purpose of Track 2 (Explainable audio deepfake detection), it is permitted to use pretrained language model checkpoints and adapt such models for the detection task of Track 2, as long as the pretrained checkpoints are publicly accessible. The pretraining checkpoint acquisition should also be documented and reported in detail in the submitted system description.

4. Participants may, in the process of constructing and training their detections systems, augment their data in the following ways, provided that the provisions of Rule 1 are respected and that the process is documented and reported in detail in the submitted system description:

   Add audio signals from external non-speech datasets (e.g. noise samples and impulse responses).

   Duplicate and manipulate existing data in a way that does not alter its linguistic contents (e.g., audio compression, resampling, and shifting of pitch).

5. Participants may use denoise and dereverberation algorithms to suppress noise and reverberation in the evaluation data, provided that any such use is documented and reported in detail in the submitted system description.

6. Participants may, in the process of constructing and training their detections systems, re-partition the training and development subsets in a way they see fit, e.g., by pooling the two to create a larger training set, or by excluding some training files, provided that the provisions of Rule 1 are respected.

7. Each evaluation sample must be scored independently, as an isolated evaluation process.

   Techniques such as domain adaption using the evaluation segments, as well as any use of evaluation data for score normalization, are strictly forbidden.

8. Participants are permitted to update their scores multiple times during the progress phase. During the evaluation phase, only a single submission will be permitted per participating team.

   Participating teams must submit a detailed system description relating to their final submission (1 per team).

9. Participants shall not make direct, public comparisons to the results or rankings of competing teams.

   This rule applies also to the disclosure of a team's own ranking which is, by definition, a comparison to the results and rankings of competing teams.

10. A team can, however, publish their own results in terms of the official evaluation metrics. A summary of the challenge results will also be prepared by the organizers. Any team wishing to retain anonymity should provide an anonymous team identifier with their registration.

The organizers reserve the right to adjust this policy prior to the scoring platform closing, to interpret the evaluation rules and to exclude systems/teams from ranking, and/or from future participation in ADD for contraventions.

Results

To be announced.

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Wechat communication group
Please scan the QR code of our official account
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